

Contract templates, scope definition frameworks, client communication scripts for boundary-setting — Action Checklist

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CHOOSE YOUR CONTRACT STRUCTURE

- ☐ **Identify Your Contract Type:** Open a document and write down whether your most common work is deliverable-based, hourly, or retainer so you choose the correct template for each engagement.
- ☐ **Select the Right Contract Archetype:** Match your contract structure to your work type—use deliverable-based for defined outputs, hourly for uncertain scope, and retainer for ongoing relationships where you need predictable income.
- ☐ **Document Your Contract Template:** Before your next client engagement, download or draft a contract template for whichever archetype fits your work so you never start a project without a signed agreement.
- ☐ **Match Contract Type to Work Style:** Review each of your current projects and assign the appropriate contract archetype to each one, ensuring you have the right structure for every engagement.

LOCK DOWN YOUR CONTRACT CLAUSES

- ☐ **Define Revision Limits in Writing:** Specify exactly how many revision rounds are included, what counts as a revision versus a redesign, and the rate you'll charge for additional rounds so clients can't demand free work.
- ☐ **Lock In Your Payment Schedule:** State deposit amounts, progress payment triggers, and final payment requirements as percentages tied to specific project milestones so you always know when money is due.
- ☐ **Add a Kill Fee Clause:** Include a clause specifying what percentage of remaining contract value you receive if a client cancels mid-project so you don't work for free on aborted projects.
- ☐ **Protect Your Intellectual Property:** Add a clause stating that IP transfers to the client only upon final payment so you retain leverage when clients delay paying their final invoice.

CREATE YOUR CHANGE PROCESS

- ☐ **Create a Scope Change Request Form:** Draft a simple form clients must use to formally request changes, including a description field and estimated impact on timeline and budget so every request is documented.
 - ☐ **Require Written Approval Before Changes:** Specify in your contract that no additional work begins until you provide a written estimate and the client approves it in writing so you never do unpaid work.
 - ☐ **Quote Your Change Fees Upfront:** When a client requests a change, calculate the additional cost and send it to them before doing any work so there's no dispute about payment later.
 - ☐ **Add Milestone Check-Ins to Every Project:** Schedule regular check-ins throughout your project where you review progress against the original scope and flag any drift immediately so scope creep doesn't accumulate unnoticed.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.